

FREE PROMPT AND SETUP GUIDE

The Vox *Collage* Kit

The exact prompt I gave Claude Code to turn a talking-head video into a Vox-style paper collage reel, plus the five minute setup. No editing app, no After Effects, no keyframes.

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WHAT YOU'LL MAKE

A collage that *acts out* your words

You talk to camera. Above you, a paper collage cuts to a new scene on every line: black and white cutouts on crumpled paper, coral and mint circles, tape and halftone, and props that act out what you say. A hand places a building, scissors cut a photo out, a magnifying glass finds the old photos, a clock spins on "days". Every cut gets a real transition.



A hand places it



A clock spins on "days"



A magnifier finds the photos



A stamp comes down

WHAT YOU NEED

- **Claude Code.** On a Pro or Max plan. It writes and runs everything: the cut, the images, the animation and the render.
- **A talking-head video.** Up to about a minute, filmed vertically or landscape. A voiceover works too.
- **A Mac or PC.** Claude installs the free tools for you (ffmpeg, Python, rembg for cutouts, Whisper for the transcript).
- **Optional:** ElevenLabs for paper sound effects, and Higgsfield for black and white prop photos like hands and scissors: higgsfield.ai.

HOW LONG IT TAKES

About an hour for the first one, most of it reviewing. The 4K render itself takes around 15 minutes.

Setup · 5 minutes

Give Claude a *video studio*

1. MAKE A PROJECT FOLDER

Create a folder, put your video in it, and open Claude Code inside that folder. Everything Claude makes will live there.

2. INSTALL HYPERFRAMES

HyperFrames is a free, open source tool that turns HTML into video, with about 450 ready-made effects (paper tears, halftone dissolves, camera shake, kinetic type). Type these two lines into Claude Code, one at a time:

```
/plugin marketplace add heygen-com/hyperframes
/plugin install hyperframes@hyperframes
```

Then restart Claude Code so it picks up the new skills.

3. LET CLAUDE INSTALL THE REST

```
Check this machine for ffmpeg, Python 3, rembg (with the u2net and
u2net_human_seg models) and a Whisper model for word-level
transcripts. Install anything that is missing, test each one on a
tiny file, and tell me what you installed.
```

4. OPTIONAL EXTRAS

- **Sound effects:** put your ElevenLabs API key in a **.env** file in the folder (ELEVENLABS_API_KEY=...). Claude uses it to make paper pops, stamps and rustles.
- **Props:** if you want hands, scissors or a clock, generate them as "black and white vintage photograph, isolated on plain white" in Higgsfield, download them into the folder, and Claude will cut them out.

> **Tip:** keep the folder somewhere with space. A minute of 4K footage plus the renders can take 5 GB.

The prompt

The one prompt *I used*

Fill in the three brackets and paste it into Claude Code. It does the whole thing and stops for your review before the final render.

```
Turn my talking-head video into a Vox-style paper collage reel. You
do all of the editing, no editing app.

My video: [file name]
My topic: [e.g. things invented in London]
My comment keyword: [e.g. CUTOUT]

1. Transcribe it with word timestamps. Keep only my last clean take
   of every line, speed everything after the hook to 1.1x, and never
   cut the end off a word. Re-listen to the cut to check.
2. Make it a split screen: the animation on top (1080x960), me
   underneath. If my footage is log (S-Log3, V-Log, C-Log), read the
   camera metadata, convert it properly, and give me 10 grade
   options as one image so I can pick a number.
3. Find real public domain or CC0 images for every idea I mention on
   Wikimedia Commons. No watermarks. Note each licence and author.
4. Cut them out with rembg, make them black and white and punchy,
   and keep one coral red accent per scene.
5. Build the top half in HyperFrames in a collage explainer style:
   crumpled white paper, scraps of grid paper, black halftone
   patches, olive tape strips, flat coral (#f2988c) and mint
   (#bfe8b0) circles, thin black arrows, crosses and outline
   sparkles, and one heavy black sans with an underscore before the
   key word (like "_animation.").
6. Cut to a new scene on every line, timed to my words. In each
   scene, props act out what I say: a hand places it, scissors cut
   it, a magnifying glass finds it, a clock spins, a stamp comes
   down. Keep the words to one short headline or tag per scene.
7. Put a designed transition between every scene: a zoom into the
   hero, a whip pan with blur, a circle wipe or a sheet of paper
   sweeping across. Bring each scene's cutouts in slightly before
   the cut, so nothing slides in empty.
8. Add paper sound effects on the visible actions (pops, stamps,
   rustles). Keep my voice on top, about -15 LUFS.
9. Render a 720p review copy and make me a page where I can leave
   timestamped notes. Only render the 4K final after I approve.
```

Before you build

Show it a *reference* first

My first version missed the mark because Claude worked from the cover image of my reference, not the video. Once it watched the reference frame by frame, the edit jumped up a level. Do this before the main prompt:

```
Here is a reference video I love: [link or file]. Download it and
study it frame by frame before you build anything. Take a frame
every half second and tell me: how long each scene lasts, the
palette (with hex codes), the fonts, the textures, how things move,
and how it gets from one scene to the next. Then build my video in
that style.
```



WHAT TO LOOK FOR

- **Scene length.** The good ones cut every 1 to 2 seconds.
- **Images over words.** The words are small. The images do the talking.
- **The transitions.** These matter more than the scenes themselves.
- **One colour accent.** Black and white cutouts with a single coral or red hit.

Instagram or Pinterest link? Claude can download most public posts. If one is blocked, open it in your browser and ask Claude to step through the video and take screenshots.

Step by step

Prefer more *control?*

Run the build in stages and review each one. These are the follow-up prompts I used.

THE CUT

```
Show me every take of every line with timestamps. Use the last
clean take of each, cut the gaps between sentences only, and
re-transcribe the finished cut word for word so we know nothing is
repeated or clipped.
```

THE IMAGES

```
For each line of my script, list the real archive images you would
use from Wikimedia Commons, with licence and author. Skip anything
with a watermark. Show me a contact sheet before you cut them out.
```

FEWER WORDS, MORE ACTION

```
It focuses on words too much. Cut every scene down to one short
headline or tag and make the images do the work: props that act out
the line, and something new landing at least every second.
```

TRANSITIONS

```
The cuts between scenes feel flat. Search the HyperFrames registry
for paper and halftone transitions and use a different one at each
cut: zoom, whip pan, circle wipe, paper sweep.
```

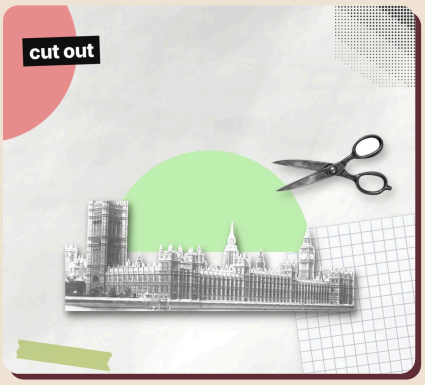
THE FINAL

```
I approve. Render the final in 4K (2160x3840): draw the animation at
double resolution and re-cut my footage from the original file.
Then make me 3 cover options in my usual cover style.
```

The look

The collage *recipe*

ELEMENT	WHAT I USED
Background	Crumpled white paper, with scraps of grid paper and more crumpled paper layered on top
Colour	coral #F2988C mint #BFE8B0 red #E2483A olive tape #B0BC62
Cutouts	Black and white, high contrast, soft drop shadow, one coral accent per scene
Type	One heavy black sans (Inter Black), left aligned, an underscore before the key word, black ribbon tags
Decoration	Thin black arrows, crosses and outline sparkles, black halftone dots in the corners
Motion	Props act out the words. A new scene every line. Slow push in on every scene
Transitions	Zoom into the hero, whip pan with blur, coral or mint circle wipe, grid paper sweep
Sound	Paper pops, stamps and rustles on every visible action, voice on top



Scissors cut it out



A finger taps play



The $29/mo balloon bursts

From my redos

Six fixes that *saved my edit*

1. **It looked grey and slow.** Claude had only seen my reference's cover. Make it study the video frame by frame first (page 5).
2. **Too many words.** One headline per scene. If a word can be a prop, make it a prop.
3. **Scenes slid in empty.** Ask for each scene's cutouts to arrive just before the cut, so the transition reveals a finished scene.
4. **My skin looked green.** Log footage needs a proper conversion, not a random LUT. Ask Claude to read the camera's metadata and give you 10 options to pick from.
5. **A paper transition rendered as blank paper.** In HyperFrames, a video inside a transition's slot isn't decoded in the final render. Use a still of the outgoing scene, with the new scene playing underneath.
6. **Watch the licences.** Public domain and CC0 need no credit. CC BY clips need the author named in your caption. Skip anything with a watermark burned in.

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